

Home Group

Fichtenstr. 2, 01097 Dresden

Led by: Stefan Helmert
Date: 08 October 2026
Time: 6:00 pm

Schedule

Time	Item
6:00 pm	Prayer
6:05 pm	Bible study (part 1 of 2: Mark 15:20–32; continued at the next meeting)
7:00 pm	In 2 groups: How are we doing? Prayer requests?
8:00 pm	Tidying up

Bible text: Mark 15:20–41

Jesus before Pilate – Crucifixion

The Crucifixion

20 When they had mocked him, they took the purple off of him, and put his own garments on him. They led him out to crucify him.

The Crucifixion and Death of Jesus

21 They compelled one passing by, coming from the country, Simon of Cyrene, the father of Alexander and Rufus, to go with them, that he might bear his cross.

22 They brought him to the place called Golgotha, which is, being interpreted, “The place of a skull.”

23 They offered him wine mixed with myrrh to drink, but he didn’t take it.

24 Crucifying him, they parted his garments among them, casting lots on them, what each should take.

25 It was the third hour when they crucified him.

26 The superscription of his accusation was written over him: “THE KING OF THE JEWS.”

27–28 With him they crucified two robbers, one on his right hand, and one on his left.

Mocked on the Cross

- 29** Those who passed by mocked him, shaking their heads and saying, “Ha! You who destroy the temple and build it in three days,
30 save yourself and come down from the cross!”
31 Likewise, also the chief priests mocking among themselves with the scribes said, “He saved others. He can’t save himself.
32 Let the Christ, the King of Israel, now come down from the cross, that we may see and believe him.” Those who were crucified with him also insulted him.

Darkness, Cry and Confession

- 33** When the sixth hour had come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.
34 At the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, “Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani?” which is, being interpreted, “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?”
35 Some of those who stood by, when they heard it, said, “Behold, he is calling Elijah!”
36 One ran, and filling a sponge full of vinegar, put it on a reed, and gave it to him to drink, saying, “Let him be. Let’s see whether Elijah comes to take him down.”
37 Jesus cried out with a loud voice, and gave up the spirit.
38 The veil of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom.
39 When the centurion, who stood by opposite him, saw that he cried out like this and breathed his last, he said, “Truly this man was the Son of God!”
40 There were also women watching from afar. Among them were both Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of James the less and of Joses, and Salome;
41 who, when he was in Galilee, followed him and served him; and many other women who came up with him to Jerusalem.

Bible text: World English Bible (public domain).

Source: <https://www.bibleserver.com/LUT/Markus15> (German version of this handout: Luther Bible 2017).

The headings correspond exactly to the structure of the source.

Questions for Analysis

Getting Started

Language

1. Which terms in the text are unclear or unfamiliar? Collect them and look them up in a Bible dictionary.

Place & Time

2. Why is the place called “the place of a skull”, and why was it outside the city (v. 22)?
3. Collect the time references (vv. 25. 33. 34) – how does the timeline run? Which festival is in the background?

Context

4. What happened immediately before (Mk 14:43–15:19)?
5. “Son of God”: Mk 1:1 ↔ v. 39 – who recognises it at the end, and why is that surprising?

Characters

6. Who acts, who speaks, who is silent in vv. 20–41? (When does Jesus himself speak?)
7. Who is missing – and why? (The disciples, Mk 14:50!)

The Crucifixion (vv. 20–28)

8. Simon is **compelled** to carry the cross (v. 21) – what does that mean for Mk 8:34 (“take up his cross”)?
9. Why does Jesus refuse the wine mixed with myrrh (v. 23)?
10. “King of the Jews” (v. 26) – written as a charge: in what sense is it true?
11. *Our lives*: Simon carries the cross for Jesus – unwillingly. What does that mean for our picture of discipleship: does it begin with us – or is it demanded of us, and then grows?

Mocked on the Cross (vv. 29–32)

12. Three groups mock – what does each throw at him, where does something repeat itself?
13. **The paradox of v. 31**: “He saved others – he cannot save himself.” How can both be true at once? Is not-being-able-to-save-himself weakness – or precisely the way he saves others?

14. Where does the mockery become unintentionally true (vv. 29. 31. 32)?
15. "... that we may see and believe" (v. 32) – why is that not a genuine condition of faith?
16. *Our lives*: Where do we (or others) demand proof first – and what would it mean to believe without proof?

Darkness, Cry and Confession (vv. 33–41)

17. "Why have you forsaken me?" (v. 34) – mere despair? (Psalm 22: a lament that turns into praise.)
18. Darkness and the torn veil (vv. 33. 38) – who acts here, what is opened or judged?
19. Why does the Roman centurion of all people confess "Son of God" (v. 39)?
20. Why do the women stay and see everything (vv. 40f) – unlike the disciples?
21. *Our lives*: When have we experienced God's nearness or forsakenness first-hand? What helped in the darkness?
22. *Our lives*: For whom can we today be there "from a distance" – staying, watching, bearing witness?

Cross References to Other Bible Passages

23. Read **Psalm 22** – which verses of our text echo it? (Compare v. 29 with Ps 22:8; v. 24 with Ps 22:19; v. 34 with Ps 22:2.)
24. **Isaiah 53**: Which features of the "suffering servant of God" (Isa 53:5.12) recur in our passage?
25. **Mk 8:31; 9:31; 10:33f**: Jesus announces his suffering three times – which of it is literally fulfilled in vv. 20–27?
26. **Mk 10:45**: "... to give his life as a ransom for many" – how does this word sound in the light of vv. 37.39?
27. **Heb 10:19f**: What does the torn veil (v. 38) mean in the light of this New Testament interpretation?
28. **Amos 8:9 / Ex 10:21f**: Which ancient motif lies behind the darkness (v. 33)?

Closing

29. The centurion recognises Jesus in the one who is dying. Where do we encounter people in "crucified" situations today?